

Simple Blog Platform

Version 1.0.0

A lightweight, beginner-friendly blogging platform built using Node.js, Express, and Vanilla JavaScript. This project is designed to be as simple as possible, utilizing in-memory arrays as a mock database instead of a complex relational database setup.

Features

- **Create Posts:** Users can submit new blog posts with a title, author name, and content.
- **Comment System:** Users can interact by adding comments to specific posts.
- **Real-time Feed:** The blog feed automatically updates to show the latest posts and their respective comments.
- **Zero Configuration:** No database setup required. The application runs immediately upon starting the server.

Prerequisites

Ensure you have the following installed on your machine:

- **Node.js** (v12.0.0 or higher)
- **npm** (Node Package Manager - comes with Node.js)

Installation & Setup

Follow these steps to get the project running locally:

1. Initialize the Project

Create a new directory for your project and initialize it with npm:

```
mkdir simple-blog  
cd simple-blog  
npm init -y
```

2. Install Dependencies

Install Express, the only required backend dependency:

```
npm install express
```

3. Project Structure

Ensure your project directory looks exactly like this:

```
simple-blog/  
├── server.js           # The Express backend server  
├── public/  
│   └── index.html     # The frontend UI  
├── package.json  
└── package-lock.json
```

Running the Application

To start the application, run the following command in your terminal:

```
node server.js
```

You should see a message in the terminal: *"Simple blog running on http://localhost:3000"*

Open your web browser and navigate to: <http://localhost:3000>

How it Works (Under the Hood)

- **Backend (`server.js`):** Hosts the RESTful API endpoints (`GET /api/posts` , `POST /api/posts` , etc.). It stores posts and comments in standard JavaScript arrays. Note that all data will be lost when the server restarts.
- **Frontend (`index.html`):** A single-page Vanilla HTML file that uses the standard `fetch()` API to send and retrieve data asynchronously from the backend without reloading the page.

Generated for the Simple Blog Platform Project